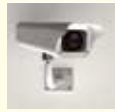


HOW SMARTPHONES CHANGED PHOTOGRAPHY

A professional photographer and his take on

how smartphone cameras have changed the world of photography forever. And whether you like it or not, this revolution is irrevocable and here to stay. <http://dgit.in/14raGbr>

BUILD YOUR OWN SURVEILLANCE SYSTEM

If you want to build a home surveillance system without breaking

the bank, make sure you don't miss this. The tutorial also tells you how to sync everything to the cloud and secure the premises of your property diligently. <http://dgit.in/19hS9VN>

HANDS-ON WITH EXFAT

An up close and personal look at Microsoft's

exFAT filesystem. It absolutely blows past the older FAT32's 4GB file size limit and borrows few features from NTFS. But is it really a saviour for cross-platform files sharing? <http://dgit.in/133Y7ap>

INSIDE THE DIGG READER

Ever since Google announced it would pull

the plug on Reader, it's RSS reader, one familiar company has been racing against time to offer us a compelling substitute. This is a chronicle of their sprint towards the finish line. <http://dgit.in/12XFeon>

Snowden blows the lid off NSA's PRISM

- Compiled by Nimish Sawant

Earlier last month, the world woke up to a shocking interview of an ex-CIA agent and technical consultant, Edward Snowden. As the video interview on The Guardian progressed (<http://dgit.in/17x93Py>), Snowden methodically ripped apart NSA's surveillance program, called PRISM, which allows US secret agencies to keep track of each and every US citizen. The program allegedly involves the collection of data from major internet giants such as Google, Microsoft, Facebook and Apple. Every sort of digital or analog communication is tracked by PRISM, helping the government build a huge database which can be used against citizens in the future, claimed Snowden. "We collect more digital communications from America than we do from the Russians," he revealed.

So every phone conversation, every email sent and received, every status update by US citizens is being stashed somewhere in the NSA's digital dungeons. This indexed data can be easily pulled up to build a case against any citizen against whom the government agency has a shred of doubt for terrorist activities or even a vendetta.

Since the Wikileaks' Iraq War documents leak by US Marine Bradley Manning (now under arrest) this is the biggest news story in the history of US secret agencies. What gives it even more gravitas, is the fact that Edward Snowden has come out in the public with this information being very aware of the fact that it may lead to incarceration or possible death by the government's "third party agencies". He could have leaked the information anonymously

and being in the position that he was, ensure that it did not track back to him. But he chose to do otherwise. "Snowden is a traitor," was the expected response from the US government agencies. But it's worth pondering why someone put his and his family's well-being at an eternal risk while he had a great job with great money in a location in Hawaii, unless he truly believed in the righteous nature of what



he was doing. Comparisons between him and whistleblower Assange are inevitable, but things aren't as black and white, as we will find out.

Obama's defence of surveillance

"When it comes to telephone calls, nobody is listening to your telephone calls. That's not what this program's about. The intelligence community is looking at phone numbers and durations of calls. They are not looking at names and not looking at content. But by sifting through this metadata, they may find potential leads to folks who might engage in terrorism. If the intelligence community wants to

listen to a phone call, they need permission from a federal judge," said Obama while defending the government's surveillance programs. The statement begs the question, "How do the agencies get a hint that X phone number is suspect by just looking at the phone number and duration of the call?" Unless you take everything Obama says at face value, the above statement needs to be looked at with a cynical view. Here is the entire video, you can judge for yourself how convincing or unconvincing Obama sounds: <http://dgit.in/174Lg5G>

Secret to Prism Program

This Associated Press story does a deep dive into the surveillance program which may have led to the alleged PRISM avatar. "This frenetic, manual process was the forerunner to PRISM, the recently revealed highly classified National Security Agency program that seizes records from Internet companies. As laws changed and technology improved, the government and industry moved toward a streamlined, electronic process, which required less time from the companies and provided the government data in a more standard format," it says. <http://dgit.in/174RVgv>

Consequences of NSA spying

In this opinion piece published on CNN, the author discusses how the NSA having access to data from American internet giants has adverse consequences globally as the majority of internet traffic flows through the United States. We use Facebook, Yahoo, Google, Microsoft products on a daily basis, but with NSA allegedly having access to these companies, it could affect all of us at some level. <http://dgit.in/19uTZiD>